



**BEFORE THE
FEDERAL MARITIME COMMISSION**

Case No.: Docket No. 22-23

MARINE TRANSPORT LOGISTICS, INC

Complainant

vs.

CMA-CGM (America), LLC

Respondent

FORMAL VERIFIED COMPLAINT

Marine Transport Logistics, Inc., (hereinafter "MTL"), by its attorney, Garry Pogil, complaining of the Respondent, CMA-CGM (America), LLC, (hereinafter "CMA") as follows, upon information, the sources of such being CMA documents and conversations between CMA and MTL:

PARTIES

1. MTL is a corporation duly organized under the laws of the State of New York, with a principal place of business at 63 New Hook Road, Bayonne, NJ 07002.

2. MTL is a Non-Vessel Operating Common Carrier (NVOCC), duly licensed by the Federal Maritime Commission (hereinafter "FMC").

3. CMA is a Vessel Operating Common Carrier (VOCC). Address: 1 Meadowlands Plz, Suite 201, East Rutherford, NJ 07073.

JURISDICTION

4. FMC has subject matter jurisdiction over the claims in this action as the above-captioned matter involves contracts for carriage of goods by sea. 46 U.S.C.S. 30701, and the Shipping Act of 1984, 46 U.S.C.S. 40101, et Seq.

FACTUAL ALLEGATIONS

Container #TGBU5073710

5. On March 3, 2022, MTL advised CMA to reroute the subject container to Port of Bremerhaven due to the ongoing conflict in Ukraine. A follow up email was sent on March 11, 2022, with an additional request to change the consignee as well.

6. On April 1, 2022, CMA advised that the subject container had been discharged in the Port of Constanta and inquired as to whether MTL wished to pick up such at that location.

7. There was no basis for CMA to inquire of MTL about picking up the container at Constanta because MTL's clear instructions were to deliver the container to Bremerhaven.

8. CMA did not immediately load the container at Constanta as they were required to do for its final destination to Bremerhaven. Instead, to collect demurrage/detention/storage charges, CMA delayed loading the container for several months and then tried to collect demurrage/storage charges in connection with such delay. Furthermore, CMA failed to advise as to the nature and extent of delay at Constanta.

9. Having not received a response from CMA, MTL followed up on April 14 and April 21, 2022, requesting clarification as to why nothing is being done while MTL's customer is being requested to pay demurrage and storage charges.

10. Meanwhile, on or about April 21, 2022, CMA contacted the Ukrainian consignee requesting demurrage and storage charges because the subject container is idling in the Port of Constanta.

11. On April 28, 2022, CMA finally notified MTL that a Change of Destination has been processed.

12. However, as of June 20, 2022, the subject container still has not been delivered to the Port of Bremerhaven. CMA finally responded to MTL by stating that the subject container will be

delivered on July 17, 2022.

13. On July 8, 2022, MTL advised CMA that CMA forgot to change the consignee and notify party for the subject container. CMA failed to respond, and another reminder was sent by MTL on July 18 and 19 of 2022. On July 19, 2022, CMA responded: "Your correction request was well received. However, because the cargo manifest has been filed with custom at the destination port, a message has been sent to the destination agents for their approval. Once we receive word from our agents, we will advise you accordingly." The consequence of such failure was that demurrage/detention/storage charges would continue to accumulate because the container could not be released without a consignee.

Container #UETU5251612

14. On March 3, 2022, MTL advised CMA to reroute the subject container to Port of Bremerhaven due to the ongoing conflict in Ukraine.

15. On March 11, 2022, a follow up has been sent to CMA by MTL. On March 25, 2022, another request was sent to CMA to change destination and the consignee. This container too ended up at the Port of Constanta. CMA did not immediately load the container at Constanta as they were required to do for its final destination to Bremerhaven. Instead, to collect demurrage/detention/storage charges, CMA delayed loading the container for several months and then tried to collect demurrage/storage charges in connection with such delay. Furthermore, CMA failed to advise as to the nature and extent of delay at Constanta.

16. On June 10, 2022, MTL sent a reminder to CMA to change the consignee. CMA responded by stating: "Your correction was well received. However, because the cargo manifest has been filed with custom at the destination port, a message has been sent to the destination agents for their approval. Once we receive word from our agents, we will advise you accordingly."

17. On June 14, 2022, CMA advised that the amended Bill of Lading has been posted;

however, the consignee was not amended by CMA. The consignee was finally corrected on the following day.

18. Irrespective of the fact that MTL had paid all freight charges, CMA delayed issuing the SWB until June 26, 2022.

Container #SEGU6471959

19. On March 3, 2022, MTL advised CMA to reroute the subject container to Port of Bremerhaven due to the ongoing conflict in Ukraine. There was no response; so a follow up was sent on March 11, 2022. This container too ended up at the Port of Constanta. CMA did not immediately load the container at Constanta as they were required to do for its final destination to Bremerhaven. Instead, to collect demurrage/detention/storage charges, CMA delayed loading the container for several months and then tried to collect demurrage/storage charges in connection with such delay. Furthermore, CMA failed to advise as to the nature and extent of delay at Constanta.

20. On June 7, 2022, MTL notified CMA that they forgot to change the consignee and notify party. Having received no reply, a follow up was sent to which CMA responded; "Your correction was well received. However, because the cargo manifest has been filed with custom at the destination port, a message has been sent to the destination agents for their approval. Once we receive word from our agents, we will advise you accordingly."

21. CMA finally corrected the consignee and sent an amended draft Bill of Lading on June 14, 2022, and MTL requested issuance of SWB urgently. Such SWB was delayed by five (5) days.

Container #UESU5180789

22. A similar picture unfolded with this container as well. On March 3, 2022, MTL advised CMA to reroute the subject container to Port of Bremerhaven due to the ongoing conflict in Ukraine. There was no response, so a follow up was sent on March 11, 2022. This container too ended up at the Port of Constanta. CMA did not immediately load the container at Constanta as

they were required to do for its final destination to Bremerhaven. Instead, to collect demurrage/detention/storage charges, CMA delayed loading the container for several months and then tried to collect demurrage/storage charges in connection with such delay. Furthermore, CMA failed to advise as to the nature and extent of delay at Constanta.

23. On June 27, MTL noticed that CMA failed to correct the consignee and notify party and advised them of such. CMA responded by stating: "Your correction was well received. However, because the cargo manifest has been filed with custom at the destination port, a message has been sent to the destination agents for their approval. Once we receive word from our agents, we will advise you accordingly."

Container #TRLU7542206

24. On March 3, 2022, MTL advised CMA to reroute the subject container to Port of Bremerhaven due to the ongoing conflict in Ukraine. There was no response, so a follow up was sent on March 11, 2022. Another follow up was sent on March 25, 2022 with a request to change the consignee. This container too ended up at the Port of Constanta. CMA did not immediately load the container at Constanta as they were required to do for its final destination to Bremerhaven. Instead, to collect demurrage/detention/storage charges, CMA delayed loading the container for several months and then tried to collect demurrage/storage charges in connection with such delay. Furthermore, CMA failed to advise as to the nature and extent of delay at Constanta.

25. On March 25, 2022, MTL notified CMA to change the consignee. The consignee was not changed, and MTL again, on June 10, 2022, notified CMA that CMA forgot to change the consignee and notify party. CMA responded, on June 12, 2022, with their standard reply: "Your correction was well received. However, because the cargo manifest has been filed with custom at the destination port, a message has been sent to the destination agents for their approval. Once we receive word from our agents, we will advise you accordingly."

26. On June 13, 2022, MTL notified CMA that irrespective of the fact that MTL requested a change in consignee on March 25, 2022, such change did not take place to date.

27. After the consignee was finally changed, CMA delayed issuing the SWB; such SWB was not issued until June 23, 2022.

28. CMA's conduct with respect to the five subject containers, which, upon information and belief, have not been released by CMA to date, is not the only evidence of the pattern of not taking timely action for the purpose of generating demurrage/detention/storage fees. MTL had previously filed a formal complaint against CMA, which subsequently settled, under Docket No. 18-07.

CAUSE OF ACTION

(Violation of Section 41102(c) of the Shipping Act)

29. Complainant repeats paragraphs 1 to 28 above.

30. Respondent violated Section 41102(c) of the Shipping Act in that such respondent failed to establish, observe, and enforce just reasonable regulations and practices relating to or connected with receiving, handling, storing, or delivery of property by failing to follow shipping instruction; failing to timely process Change in Destination in a manner that would avoid demurrage/storage/detention charges, which would allow for the release of the subject containers; by failing to provide timely, accurate and complete accounting of demurrage/storage/detention charges; and by failing to include accurate aspects of such charges in the service contract as provided by CMA.

DAMAGES

31. As a direct result of the foregoing, Complainant is seeking actual and consequential damages, including loss of business to MTL, in the amount of \$600,000.

WHEREFORE:

- a. Complainant is not requesting an oral hearing.
- b. Complainant is seeking reparations in the amount as indicated under the Damages section of this Complaint.
- c. Any other relief that the Court deems just and proper.

by:



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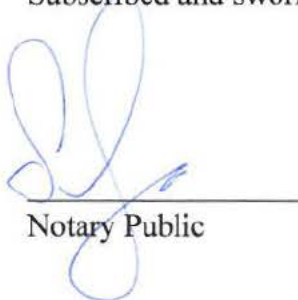
VERIFICATION

Alla Solovyeva, being duly sworn, states that she is the President of MTL (Complainant), and that the foregoing is true to her own knowledge, except as to matters herein stated to be alleged on information and belief. As to the matters stated to be alleged on information and belief, Complainant believes them to be true.



Alla Solovyeva

Subscribed and sworn to before me this 18 day of August, 2022



Notary Public

